of civilian deaths were widely believed by Pakistanis, who saw the strikes as a flagrant violation of Washington's purported support for human rights.

## DRONE ATTACKS IN PAKISTAN: 2005–15

According to another estimate made by The Bureau of Investigative Journalism, the cumulative statistics about the US drone strikes (as of 17 September 2017) are as follows:

- Total strikes: 429
- Total killed: 2,514–4,023
- Civilians killed: 424–969
- Children killed: 172–207
- Injured: 1,162–1,749
- Strikes under the Bush Administration: 51
- Strikes under the Obama Administration: 373
- Strikes under the Trump Administration: 5
- 84 of the 2,379 deaths have been identified as members of Al Qaeda

### *Was the drone campaign a good strategy?*

Despite the public outcry and politicians' weak protests following suit, many considered drone attacks a good strategy that not only shattered Al Qaeda's command and control in FATA but also struck effectively at the hierarchy of TTP. The number of TTP leaders killed by drones was higher than that of Al Qaeda. However, the drone campaign was always considered a double-edged weapon. On the one hand, it killed wanted AQ and TTP militants with precision and accuracy and effectively created a dent in their command and control structure. On the other hand, it generated acute hatred and feelings of vengeance among the people of Pakistan in general and in the people of KP, FATA in particular. It gave rise to more militants and suicide bombers. TTP proved to be the sort of terrorist organisation that did not crumble due to death of its leaders. Therefore, killing of terrorists through drones at the cost of producing three times more militants needed to be particularly considered. A strategy that produced more militants than killed needed serious review because the basic rule of effective COIN strategy urges to isolate the militants from the people in 'which they swim':